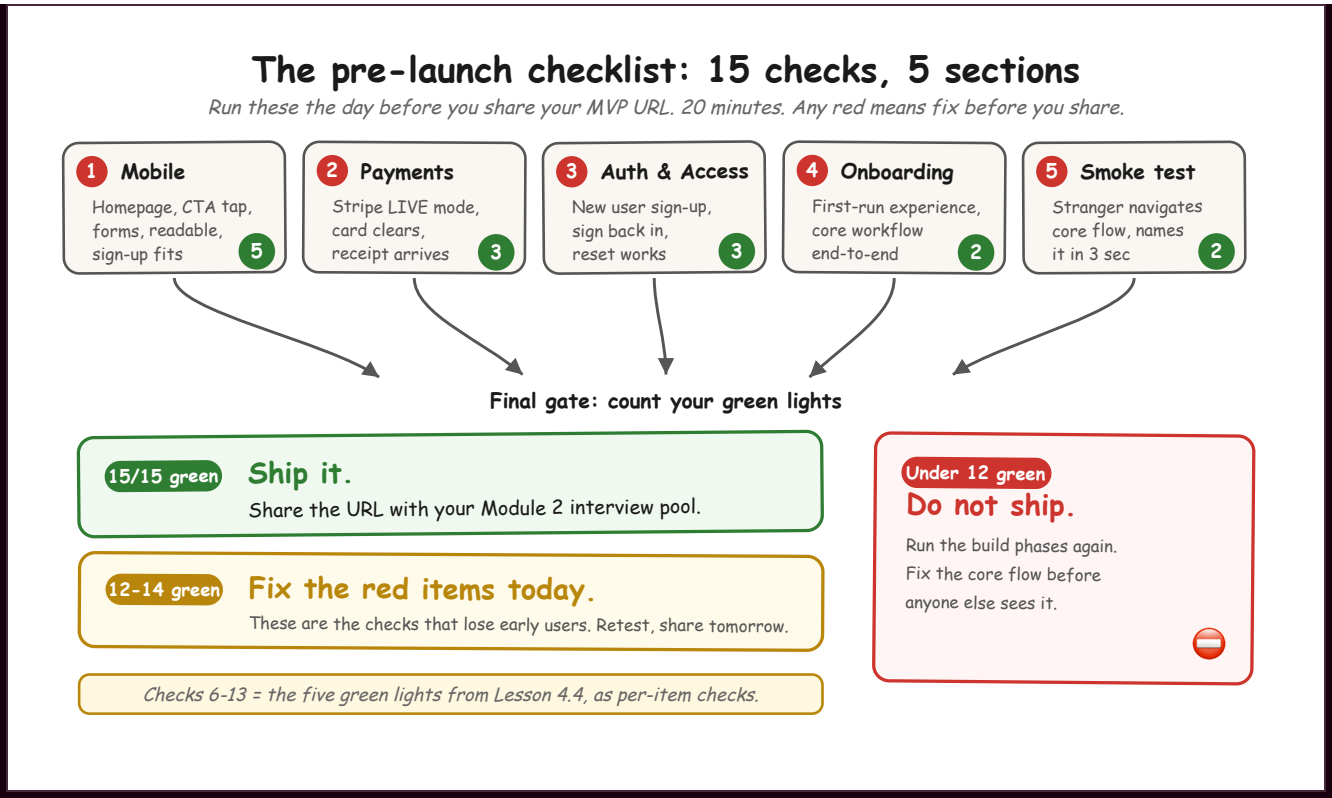
MVP Pre-Launch Checklist: 15 Items

JETTHOUGHTS TEAM FREE LESSON

> **Template companion to Module 4 — Build It Yourself** · From Idea to First Paying Customer
>
> **Run this:** the day before you share your MVP URL with anyone outside your own computer. 20 minutes. 15 items.

You validated the problem, wrote the brief, set up the stack, and shipped four build phases. One thing stands between your staging URL and a user you do not know touching it: a pre-launch check that catches the pain points real users hit in the first 60 seconds — before they bounce and never come back.



Run these 15 checks in order. Each takes under 2 minutes. All 15 green means you can send the URL with confidence. Any red means fix it before you share — a signup who hits a broken checkout on day one rarely comes back, and you may never know they were there.

Prefer paper? Download the PDF — same content, print-ready.

SECTION 1: MOBILE (5 CHECKS)

#	CHECK	HOW TO VERIFY
1	**Mobile homepage loads**	Open URL on phone. No horizontal scroll? ☐ Pass ☐ Fail
2		

CTA button tappable

HOW TO VERIFY

Tap with thumb. Responds? No overlap? ☐ Pass ☐ Fail

#

3

CHECK

Form fields work

HOW TO VERIFY

Tap each input. Right keyboard type? ☐ Pass ☐ Fail

#

4

CHECK

Text readable without zoom

HOW TO VERIFY

Arm’s length. Readable without pinching? ☐ Pass ☐ Fail

#

5

CHECK

Sign-up flow on mobile

HOW TO VERIFY

Full sign-up fits screen? No cut-off buttons? ☐ Pass ☐ Fail

SECTION 2: PAYMENTS (3 CHECKS)

#

6

CHECK

Stripe in LIVE mode

HOW TO VERIFY

Dashboard toggle on “Live” not “Test”? ☐ Pass ☐ Fail

#	CHECK	HOW TO VERIFY
7	**Real card clears paywall**	$1 purchase. Webhook fires? Row flips to “paid”? □ Pass □ Fail
8	**Receipt email arrives**	Check inbox. Correct product name and price? □ Pass □ Fail

---

SECTION 3: AUTH & ACCESS (3 CHECKS)

#	CHECK	HOW TO VERIFY
9	**New user can sign up**	Fresh email, incognito. Logged in without errors? □ Pass □ Fail
10	**User can sign back in**	Close incognito, re-open, log in. App remembers them? □ Pass □ Fail
11		

CHECK

Password reset works

HOW TO VERIFY

Email within 2 min? Link works? ☐ Pass ☐ Fail

SECTION 4: ONBOARDING (2 CHECKS)

#

12

CHECK

First-run experience

HOW TO VERIFY

New email. First screen: blank page or prompt? ☐ Pass ☐ Fail

#

13

CHECK

Core workflow end-to-end

HOW TO VERIFY

Core job done without help? ☐ Pass ☐ Fail

SECTION 5: THE ONE-HUMAN SMOKE TEST (2 CHECKS)

#

14

CHECK

One stranger navigates core flow

HOW TO VERIFY

Send URL to someone new. No instructions. Note stalls. ☐ Pass ☐ Fail

#

15

CHECK

They can name product in 3 sec

HOW TO VERIFY

“What does this do?” Clear answer? □ Pass □ Fail

FINAL GATE

COUNT

15/15 green

VERDICT

Ship it. Share the URL with your Module 2 interview pool (see Lesson 4.4 handoff).

COUNT

12–14 green

VERDICT

Fix the red items today. They are the ones that will lose you early users.

COUNT

Under 12 green

VERDICT

Do not ship yet. Run the build phases again (back to Lesson 4.4) and fix the core flow before anyone else sees it.

Checks 6–13 (payments, auth, onboarding) are the five green lights from Lesson 4.4, broken into per-item checks – if the lights were green there, these should pass here.

> **Done:** all 15 checks passed (or a fix list for every red item). Your MVP URL is ready for real users.
>
> **You have now:** a live MVP at a real URL (Lesson 4.4) + a clean pre-launch audit (this page) + all 5 green lights from Lesson 4.4 confirmed. The launch is ready.

> **Next:** 5.1 – Run the 40% Must-Have Test Before Ads – runs the Sean Ellis 40% test on the users this MVP collects.
>
> **If blocked:** see the per-check notes above. For deeper troubleshooting, open the full build guide.

Built by JetThoughts as part of the From Idea to First Paying Customer free curriculum.

BUILT IT AND NEED ENGINEERS NEXT?

The course is written by JetThoughts, building software since 2008 and rated 4.8/5 on Clutch.

[HOW THE SPRINT WORKS]

JETTHOUGHTS